

Chapter 68 Part 2

"About those rumors." Liang Shi asked, "Have you ever believed them?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned and shook her head. "No."

"You're so certain?" Liang Shi was surprised. "Normally, wouldn't you have some doubts?"

"There are too many rumors in this circle, and many don't match reality. Today you walk together with someone, and the next day there might be news that you two are engaged." Xu Qingzhu smiled slightly. "Rumors stop with the wise¹."

Liang Shi: "....."

"But what if it's true?" Liang Shi said, "You'd miss out on your biological parents."

"It's fine." Xu Qingzhu said, "I have parents now."

She paused, and after fastening her seatbelt, looked at Liang Shi. "Teacher Liang, do you think we're still at an age when we need parents?"

Liang Shi's breath caught. "Huh?"

"If those rumors are true, then my father has also passed away." Xu Qingzhu said, "There's no point in me agonizing over these things. Including you—you say you want to go find your biological parents now. I'm not against it, but I can only say the results may not be satisfactory."

It was cold, and the heating was on in the car.

Xu Qingzhu rationally analyzed the current situation for her. "If what Mrs. Liang said is true, then you were abandoned. So what happens after you find them? They may already have another child, or have each formed their own families. Your appearance might make them feel awkward. If their financial situation is good, their children might worry you'll divide the family assets. If their financial situation isn't good, you might have to support them. The best outcome is actually finding them, but everyone being well in their own lives."

Liang Shi: "....."

She had to admit, what Xu Qingzhu said made a lot of sense.

Although it was somewhat cold.

Actually, for Liang Shi, she had never had the thought of finding her biological parents.

The reasons were similar to what Xu Qingzhu said.

They had indeed passed the age when they needed parents to give them love, so there was no need to be fixated on it.

If they naturally found them, then they'd acknowledge the relationship.

If the other party was unwilling, then they'd treat it as if there was nothing.

Anyway, they'd made it through so many storms and trials over the years. There was no need to create more trouble for themselves because of this kind of thing.

Liang Shi nodded, agreeing with her statement. "Teacher Xu, I think the same way."

Xu Qingzhu found a cushion to pad against the car window and leaned lightly against it to rest. "That's pretty good then."

Liang Shi hesitated for a moment, then said again, "You just said if I was curious about your affairs, I could ask directly, right?"

"Mm." Xu Qingzhu said, "But I may not necessarily answer."

Since Xu Qingzhu said so, Liang Shi's courage grew a bit more, but she confirmed with her again. "I can ask whatever I want, and you won't get angry, right?"

Xu Qingzhu frowned, as if in disbelief. "You're not going to ask some idiotic question, are you?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"That depends on what your standard for 'idiotic' is." Liang Shi said.

Xu Qingzhu: ".....It better be worth answering."

After thinking, Liang Shi decided to ask anyway.

"Haven't you thought about getting a DNA test?" Liang Shi asked, "The results come out in two hours. Why keep guessing back and forth?"

"I'm not guessing." Xu Qingzhu said matter-of-factly, "You're the one who's curious. I've basically never been curious about it."

Liang Shi: "?"

In that instant, she felt that Xu Qingzhu's rationality might exceed her imagination.

Could there really be someone in this world who could suppress their curiosity like this?

Liang Shi considered herself not someone with very strong curiosity. In the past, everyone thought she was so laid-back she didn't seem human.

But after coming here, her worldview had been refreshed again and again, and she'd become curious about all sorts of things.

Her life was like a puzzle missing many pieces.

At first it was fine—she could convince herself not to care about it.

But now, as more and more puzzle pieces appeared, it was like having obsessive-compulsive disorder. She had to complete this puzzle, so she kept digging for the truth.

She simply couldn't suppress her curiosity anymore.

But Xu Qingzhu could actually suppress it in this kind of matter.

Liang Shi's astonished expression was too obvious, making Xu Qingzhu chuckle softly. "Very surprised?"

Liang Shi nodded frantically.

Xu Qingzhu's cool voice rang out in the car. "When I was young, my grandparents would often mention my uncle. They would occasionally complain that he had no sense of responsibility and wouldn't inherit the family business. Occasionally when they thought of him, they would shed tears and cherish his memory. But to me, he was just a name. I'd never met him. Even after my grandparents passed away, our family didn't have a single photo of my uncle."

"Every year, my mom would take us to pay respects at my uncle's grave, and she would say she was taking good care of us, with special emphasis on me." Xu Qingzhu said, "And my parents are the best choice for me."

She looked at Liang Shi. "A person has two sets of parents in their life—one set that gave birth to you, and another set that raised you. Comparatively, I recognize the latter. And since they all chose to keep it from me, it shows they don't want me to know. My childhood was happy, and my growth process went smoothly. There's no need to be curious about this kind of thing and make everyone uncomfortable."

Liang Shi: "....."

This hit Liang Shi right in the heart.

In an instant, her perspective broadened!

Liang Shi had previously thought Xu Qingzhu didn't know, but actually Xu Qingzhu just didn't want to pierce through it.

The people who loved her had woven a mirage² for her, so she stayed within that mirage.

Xu Qingzhu wasn't curious, so she didn't believe the rumors and didn't investigate.

"What about your aunt?" Liang Shi asked again, "You've never been curious about her either?"

"My uncle never married in his life. There was only one girlfriend whose name was known, and she disappeared after my uncle passed away." Xu Qingzhu chuckled softly. "Where would I have an aunt?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She was the narrow-minded one.

She suddenly understood that this 1.3 million was a pit dug by the system.

It was impossible to get.

Damn system!

Liang Shi cursed silently in her heart.

Footnotes

¹ *"Rumors stop with the wise"* - This is a Chinese proverb "谣言止于智者" (yáoyán zhǐ yú zhìzhě), meaning that wise or intelligent people don't believe or spread rumors, thus stopping their circulation.

² *Mirage* - The Chinese term used is "海市蜃楼" (hǎishì shènlóu), which literally means "sea market mirage" and refers to an optical illusion or something beautiful but illusory and unattainable. Here it metaphorically represents the beautiful but potentially false reality Xu Qingzhu's family created for her.